

SYLLABUS FOR MSS-J135

GOVERNMENT

GENERAL OBJECTIVES:

At the end of the series of courses, candidates should be able to:

- i. analyse the basic concepts, principles, institutions and issues in government and politics, public administration and international relations;
- ii. explain the structure, institutions and processes of government;
- iii. discuss the different stages of historical, political and constitutional development of Nigeria from pre-colonial era to the present;
- iv. evaluate the political systems of different African states; and
- v. discuss the critical issues in African government and politics.

FIRST SEMESTER COURSES

GOV 001: ELEMENTS OF GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS (3 Units)

GOV 002: IDEOLOGIES & PROCESSES OF GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS (3 Units)

SECOND SEMESTER COURSES

GOV 003: NIGERIAN GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS (3 Units)

GOV 004: AFRICAN GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS (3 Units)

COURSE DESCRIPTION

GOV 001: ELEMENTS OF GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Specific Objectives

At the end of the course, the candidates are expected to:

- i. describe the subject matter of Government and politics;
- ii. explain the general application of politics to issues in the political structure; and
- iii. identify the institutions and processes within their political environment.

Course content

S/N	TOPIC	SUB-TOPIC	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Nature of Government and Politics	Definitions of government and politics, Rationale for studying government as an academic discipline, Arguments on the scientific status of politics.	The candidates are expected to have deep knowledge and understanding of the subject matter of government and politics for general application to issues in the political structure, institutions and processes.
		Methods/Approaches to the Study of government and politics.	i. Philosophical ii. Normative iii. Institutional iv. Historical v. Comparative vi. Qualitative and Quantitative vii. Behavioural viii. Empirical.
		Relationship between the study of government/politics and other academic disciplines.	i. History ii. Law iii. Economics iv. Geography v. Sociology and vi. Psychology
		Scope of government and politics.	i. Political Theory ii. Political Economy iii. International Relations iv. Public Administration v. Local Government vi. Comparative Politics vii. Peace and Conflict Studies viii. Security Studies and Development Studies.
2	Basic Concepts of Government and Politics	Power, Influence, Authority, Legitimacy, Sovereignty, Nation, Political Culture, Political Socialization, Political Participation.	
3	Meaning and Nature of the State	Definition, Purpose and Functions of the Modern state, Theories of the State,	

		Characteristics of the State.	
		Types of State.	i. Unitary ii. Federal iii. Confederal
4	The Structure and Types of Government	Structure of Government.	i. Executive ii. Legislature iii. Judiciary
		Functions, relationships, strengths and weaknesses of the executive, legislature and judiciary.	
		Types of government.	i. Democracy ii. Monarchy iii. Oligarchy iv. Aristocracy v. Military vi. Theocracy and vii. Gerontocracy
		Systems of Government.	i. Presidential ii. Parliamentary iii. Republican iv. Unitary v. Federal vi. Confederal
		Differences between government and governance.	
5	Constitution and Constitutionalism	Definition of Constitution	
		Types of Constitution	i. Written and Unwritten ii. Unitary and Federal and iii. Flexible and Rigid.
		Objectives of a Constitution	i. Empowering States ii. Establishing values and goals iii. Providing Government stability iv. Protecting freedom and Legitimizing regimes.
		Definition of Constitutionalism	

		Features of Constitutionalism	i. Rule of law ii. Separation of Powers iii. Supremacy of the Constitution iv. Fundamental Human Rights v. Independence of the Judiciary vi. Checks and Balances
		The relationship between Constitution and Constitutionalism.	
6	Citizenship	Meaning of citizenship, Ways of acquiring citizenship, Rights of citizens, Duties and obligations of citizens.	

GOV 002: IDEOLOGIES & PROCESSES OF GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Specific Objectives

At the end of the course, the candidates should be able to:

- explain the major political thoughts such as social contract and the utilitarian theories;
- discuss the concept of ideology;
- explain political Parties, Party systems and Pressure Groups;
- describe public opinion, propaganda, elections and electoral systems; and
- discuss public administration and international relations.

Course Content

S/NO	TOPICS	SUB-TOPIC	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Political thoughts and ideologies	Major Political Thoughts.	At the end of the course the students should be able to explain the major political thoughts such as: - Social Contract Theory by Thomas Hobbes - John Locke - Jean Jacques Rousseau - Utilitarianism by John Stuart Mill and Jeremy Bentham.
		The Meaning, Nature and Functions of Ideology.	

		Types of Ideology.	i. Communalism ii. Feudalism iii. Capitalism and Imperialism iv. Fascism and Nazism v. Marxism, Socialism and Communism vi. Authoritarianism vii. Totalitarianism viii. Anarchism ix. Feminism x. Environmentalism
2	Political Parties, Party systems and Pressure Groups	Definitions and Functions of Political Parties	Organs of Political Parties
		Types of Political Parties, Meaning and types of Party system, Relationship between Party Systems and Political Parties, Meaning, Types and Functions of Pressure Groups, Modes of operation of Pressure Groups, Comparison between Political Parties and Pressure Groups.	
3	Public Opinion and Propaganda	Definition, Functions and Measurement of Public Opinion, Meaning and Nature of Propaganda, Function and Strategies of Propaganda.	
4	Elections and Electoral Systems	Definition of Election, Purpose of Elections.	
		Types of elections	i. Primary election ii. General election iii. Bye-election iv. Run-off election etc.
		Meaning, Evolution and types of Suffrage, Meaning, conditions and factors militating against the conduct of free and fair election, Meaning and types of electoral systems, Historical background of elections in Nigeria,	
		Election management bodies in Nigeria.	i. FEDECO ii. NECON iii. NEC iv. INEC.
		General Elections in Nigeria.	i. 1959 ii. 1964

			iii. 1979 iv. 1983 v. 1993 vi. 1999 vii. 2003 viii. 2007 ix. 2011 x. 2015 and 2019.
		Problems of Elections in Nigeria	
5	Public Administration	Meaning of public administration, Differences and similarities between public and private administration,	
		Theories of Public Administration	i. Administrative theory ii. Scientific management theory iii. Bureaucratic theory iv. Human relation theory
		Characteristics and functions of the Civil Service.	
		The Policy Process.	i. Policy Formulation ii. Implementation and iii. Evaluation.
		Meaning, functions and challenges of public corporations in Nigeria, Meaning, functions and challenges of the local government in Nigeria.	
6	International Relations	Meaning of International Relations, Difference between International Relations and International Politics, Meaning and Objectives of Foreign Policy, The Determinants of Foreign Policy in Nigeria, Meaning and impact of globalization.	
		History, Structure, Achievements and Failures of International Organizations.	i. ECOWAS ii. African Union iii. Commonwealth of Nations iv. United Nations v. International Monetary Fund (IMF) and vi. World Bank.

GOV 003 NIGERIAN GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Specific Objectives

At the end of the course, the candidates should be able to:

- i. describe the various precolonial systems in Nigeria;
- ii. account for the Nigerian past with a view to understanding the future government and politics;
- iii. explain the evolution of the various political parties in Nigeria;
- iv. discuss the major political crises in Nigeria; and
- v. give account of the military rule in Nigeria.

Course Content

S/NO	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Pre-colonial Systems of Government in Nigeria	The system of government in precolonial Hausa/Fulani, The system of government in precolonial Yoruba, The system of government in precolonial Igbo.	At the end of the course the students should be able to explain the pre-colonial, colonial and post-colonial histories of Nigeria.
2	Colonial Administration in Nigeria	Amalgamation of Northern and Southern Nigeria in 1914, Constitutional Development in Nigeria: 1922-1960, Indirect Rule in Nigeria, The growth and effects of Nationalism in Nigeria, Constitutional Development in Nigeria: 1960 to Present.	
3	Development of Political Parties in Nigeria	Colonial and First Republic Political Parties.	i. Nigerian National Democratic Party (NNDP) ii. Nigerian Youth Movement (NYM) iii. National Council of Nigeria and Cameroons (NCNC) iv. Action Group (AG) v. Northern Peoples' Congress (NPC) vi. NEPU, UMBC, NNDP, NDC, UNIP

		Second Republic Political Parties.	i. National Party of Nigeria (NPN) ii. Unity Party of Nigeria (UPN) iii. Nigeria Peoples' Party (NPP) iv. Great Nigeria Peoples' Party (GNPP) v. Peoples' Redemption Party (PRP) vi. Nigeria Advance Party (NAP)
		Third Republic Political Parties.	i. National Republican Convention (NRC) ii. Social Democratic Party (SDP)
		Fourth Republic Political Parties.	i. All Peoples' Party (APP) ii. Peoples' Democratic Party (PDP) iii. Alliance for Democracy (AD) iv. Action Congress of Nigeria (ACN) v. Congress for Progressive Change (CPC) vi. All Progressives Congress (APC) - All Progressive Grand Alliance (APGA), etc.
4	Major Political Crises in Nigeria	Aba women riot of 1929, the Kano riots 1953, Action Group crisis of 1962, the census crisis of 1962/63, Nigerian-Biafra civil war of 1967 to 1970,	
		Electoral crises in Nigeria.	June 12 1993, 2011 post-election violence
		Niger Delta crisis, Boko Haram terrorism, Farmer-Herder conflicts.	
5	Military Intervention in Politics	Characteristics of Military rule in Africa, Reasons for Military Intervention/Coup d'état,	

		Military intervention in selected African countries.	i. Nigeria ii. Ghana iii. Liberia iv. Uganda v. Egypt vi. Congo etc.
		Disengagement of Military from Politics: Transition Programmes, Background to Military Rule in Nigeria, The Military Regimes of Ironsi, Gowon, Muritala, Obasanjo, Buhari/Idiagbon, Babangida, Abacha, and Abdulsalami Abubakar, Achievements and Failures of Military Rule in Nigeria, Panacea to preventing military intervention in Nigerian politics	

GOV 004: African Government and Politics

Specific Objectives

At the end of the course, the students should be able to:

- i. discuss Africa before European Invasion;
- ii. describe European invasion of Africa;
- iii. explain Colonial Systems of Administration in Africa;
- iv. analyse the Nationalist Movement in West Africa; and
- v. discuss the critical issues in African government and politics.

Course Content

S/N	TOPICS	SUB-TOPICS	DETAILS & NOTES
1	Africa before European Invasion	Major contributions of Africa to the world civilization before European Invasion.	At the end of the course the students should be able to explain i. Africa before European invasion ii. Contribution of manpower for building the new world iii. Development of the writing technology

			iv. European invasion of Africa v. Colonial systems of administration in Africa vi. The nationalist movement in West Africa and critical issues in African government and politics
		Establishment and maintenance of self-reliant political empires such as Ghana, Mali and Songhai empires as well as Zulu, Kanem-Bornu and Benin kingdoms	
2	European invasion of Africa	Strategies of European invasion of Africa	i. Slave trade ii. Legitimate trade iii. Missionaries iv. Colonialism v. Treaties of friendship and Protection vi. Military Conquests (Wars)
		Reasons for European Expansion to Africa, The Scramble for and Partitioning of Africa (emphasis on Berlin Conference -1884-1885), Apartheid Regime in South Africa	
		African Responses to European	i. Invasion ii. Resistance iii. Negotiations iv. Settlement of Europeans
		Meaning, origin and manifestations of Neocolonialism in Africa	
3	Colonial Systems of Administration in Africa	Indirect Rule System, Policies of Assimilation and Association	
4	The Nationalist Movements in West Africa	Nationalist Movements in British West Africa, Nationalist Movements in French West Africa	

5	Critical Issues in African Government and Politics	Democratization and Political Process in Africa, Democracy and Human Rights in Africa, Ethnicity, Poverty, Leadership problems, Migration and Human Trafficking.	
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RECOMMENDED TEXTS

1. Adamolekun, L. (2004). *Politics and Administration in Nigeria*. Ibadan: Spectrum Books Limited.
2. Anifowose, R. and Enemuo, F. (eds.) (1999). *Elements of Politics*. Lagos: Sam Iroanusi Publishers.
3. Anyabolu, I. O. (2000). *Nigeria: Past to Present*. Enugu: Classic Publishing Company Limited.
4. Appadorai, A. (1979). *The Substance of Politics*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
5. Awofeso, O. (2014). *Constitutional Development in Nigeria: Historical and Political Analysis*. Lagos: MacGrace Publishers.
6. Bassey, O.C and Ozumba G.O (eds) (2012). *Introduction to Political Science*. Lagos: Concept Publications.
7. Ebegbulem, J.C. (2016) *Government and Politics of the Modern State*. Calabar: Clearliness Publications Limited.
8. Eminue, O. (2001) *Introduction to Political Science*. Calabar: Cats Publishers.
9. Ezeani E.O (2006). *Fundamentals of Public Administration*. Enugu: Snaap Press Publishers Nigeria Limited.
10. Ezeibe, C. (2016) *ABC of Political Economy: A Beginner's Guide to Understanding the State and Economy*. Nsukka: University Press.
11. Heywood, A. (2007) *Politics* (3rd ed). Hampshire: Palgrave Macmillan.
12. Koonings, K. and Kruijt, D. (eds.) (2002). *Political Armies: The Military and Nation Building in the Age of Democracy*. London and New York: Zed Books.
13. Nnoli, O. (1978). *Ethnic Politics in Nigeria*. Enugu: Four. (2003). *Introduction to Politics*. Enugu: PARCREP Publishers.
14. Oguonu, C.N. (2014) *Management and Development: A Contemporary Reading in Public Administration*. Abuja: Premium Publishing House.
15. Okolie, A. M and Onah, V.C (eds). (2016). *Politics and Law in Africa*. Abakaliki: Appleseed and Willyrose.
16. Omotosho, M (2012). *Basic Concepts in Citizenship*. Kaduna: T90 Publicity.
17. Oyediran, O (2007). *Nigerian Constitutional Development*. Ibadan: Oyediran Consults International
18. Oyediran, O *et al.* (eds.) (2011). *New Approach: Government*. Lagos: Longman.
19. Oyediran, O. (1998). *Introduction to Political Science*. Ibadan: Oyediran Consults International.
20. Rumki, B. (2005). *Public Administration: Concepts and Theories*. New Delhi: Sterling Publishers Private Limited.
21. Stillman, R. (2009). *Public Administration: Concepts and Cases* (9th ed). Boston Wadsworth: Cengage Learning.
22. Subrata, M and Sushila R. (2007). *A History Political Thought: Plato to Marx*. New Delhi: Prentice-Hall of India Private Limited.

23. Thompson, A. (2016). *An Introduction to African Politics* (4th ed.). London: Routledge.